

WHEN TO USE RATATOSK

Ratatosk is most useful when an organization's operational systems no longer tell a consistent story about the business. It is designed as a diagnostic step before large technology or process decisions are made.

Common Situations Where Ratatosk Is Valuable:

Reporting Doesn't Reconcile

Different reports show different numbers for revenue, customers, inventory, or orders. Finance, sales, and operations rely on different data sources to answer the same questions.

Systems Don't Agree on Core Definitions

Key business entities such as customers, products, jobs, or vendors are defined differently across systems like CRM, ERP, accounting, and spreadsheets.

Shadow Systems Have Appeared

Teams have started maintaining spreadsheets or independent databases because the official systems cannot answer the questions they need answered.

Integrations Are Breaking or Fragile

APIs, integrations, or manual exports between systems require constant maintenance, and small changes often create downstream data issues.

ERP or System Projects Are Stalling

Organizations preparing for an ERP implementation, migration, or replacement often discover that underlying data definitions are inconsistent across departments.

Operational Decisions Depend on Manual Reconciliation

Teams spend time manually reconciling numbers across systems before leadership can make decisions.

Leadership Suspects Structural Data Problems

Executives feel that the systems supporting the business are not aligned but lack a clear picture of where the conflicts actually exist.

Mergers, Acquisitions, or System Consolidation

Before integrating organizations or replacing major systems, it is critical to understand how each system defines and stores core business entities.

What Ratatosk Provides:

A Ratatosk engagement begins with a structured workshop to inventory systems and identify how core business entities are defined across them. The analysis produces a set of executive-level artifacts, including:

- Executive Summary
- Governance Summary
- Data Ecosystem Map
- Conflict Coverage Report

These outputs reveal where systems agree, where they conflict, and where operational risk exists due to inconsistent data definitions.

Ratatosk does not replace ERP, CRM, or reporting tools. Instead, it helps organizations understand how those systems interact and where alignment is required before major operational or technology changes are made.